SIH 26265 — UNDERSTANDING THE PROBLEM

Code Blooded | AICTE | Plain-English team briefing

In one sentence: Build a secure portal to help institutions and AICTE track, verify and manage security deposits / Fixed Deposit Receipts (FDRs) from submission through renewal and eventual release.

1. What is an FDR and why does it matter?

A Fixed Deposit Receipt (FDR) is evidence that money has been deposited with a bank for a set period. Under applicable AICTE rules, an institution or its sponsoring Trust/Society may need to maintain a prescribed security deposit. Conditions can include a lien or restriction, meaning withdrawal needs the required authorisation. The deposit acts as a financial safeguard in specified circumstances.

Important: Amounts, duration, lien wording and release conditions depend on the applicable Approval Process Handbook (APH) and institution category. Do not assume one rule applies to every institution.

2. What is the real problem today?

An FDR is not just a document to collect once. Its lifecycle includes submission, verification, maturity monitoring, renewal when required, and release only after required checks. When details are spread across PDFs, emails, spreadsheets and manual follow-ups, important information can be missed.

• **Verification risk:** A PDF can look genuine but contain incorrect or altered details. A document image alone does not prove that the bank issued it or that a required lien is active.

• **Expiry risk:** Maturity dates can be overlooked; institutions may not get reminders early enough and officers may not see overdue cases.

• **Scattered information:** Documents, correspondence, verification results and decisions may be stored separately, hiding the full case status.

• **Release delays:** Matured deposits may require several checks and authorised approvals. Manual routing can slow progress and make it hard to see who must act next.

3. Why does this process exist?

The regulator needs confidence that a required deposit exists, meets applicable conditions and remains valid for the required period. Later, the deposit may mature, need renewal, become disputed or be considered for release. Every transition needs evidence, checks and an accountable decision.

Typical lifecycle

1. Submit	2. Verify	3. Monitor	4. Renew / mature	5. Review release
Institution enters FDR details and uploads evidence.	Check fields; use authorised source where possible.	Track status and upcoming dates.	Notify users; record renewal or maturity.	Route checks to authorised officers; record decision.

4. What does SIH want us to build?

A working FDR/security-deposit lifecycle portal—not just an upload form. It should show each deposit’s status, help verify submitted information, alert people before deadlines and provide a traceable workflow for decisions.

Core modules

Module	What it does
Institution portal / digital vault	Institution users enter FDR number, bank, amount, dates, Trust/Society and linked institution; upload evidence and view status.
Verification workflow	Validate required fields and compare details with a bank/authorised source where available. For the hackathon demo, a clearly labelled mock-bank API can simulate responses.
Maturity and renewal alerts	Scheduled checks identify upcoming maturity dates; reminders and dashboards show due-soon, overdue or renewal-evidence-pending records.
AICTE dashboard	Queues for pending verification, upcoming maturity, overdue renewal, disputes and release requests; filters and case assignment.
Release / clearance workflow	Record a release request, route checks to authorised officers, capture reasons and approvals, and maintain an audit log. Do not auto-release funds.
Security and audit trail	Role-based access; record who changed what and when, with reasons and timestamps.

HOW OUR PROTOTYPE SHOULD WORK

5. Who uses the portal?

• **Institution / Trust user:** submits FDR details, uploads evidence, checks status, responds to deficiencies and requests renewal or release where permitted.

• **AICTE officer:** reviews queues, checks evidence, records observations and makes decisions within their authority.

• **System scheduler:** checks dates, creates reminders and records notification events.

6. Suggested demo flow

1. Log in as an institution and submit a sample FDR with bank, reference number, amount and maturity date.
2. Validate fields and call a mock verification service.
3. Show results such as “verified in simulation”, “mismatch”, “pending” or “manual review required”.
4. Show a record maturing soon and trigger an automatic reminder.
5. Log in as an AICTE officer and view pending verification, expiring FDRs and overdue cases.
6. Submit a release request for a matured sample record; show clearance steps, officer review, final decision and audit history.

7. What is our USP?

One connected lifecycle: verification + deadline monitoring + role-based queues + traceable release workflow. A mock-bank API demonstrates how an external service could be integrated. It is a simulation—not proof that a real bank verified the FDR.

8. Technical concepts in simple words

Concept	Meaning
Frontend	Screens used by institutions and officers; e.g. React.
Backend API	Server that checks permissions, validates input and applies workflow rules; e.g. Node.js/Express.
Database	Stores Trusts, Institutions, FDR records, verification results, alerts, release requests and audit events.
Scheduled job	Background task that checks dates and triggers reminders; e.g. node-cron.
Mock-bank API	Separate demo service returning controlled test responses for an FDR reference.
Audit log	Traceable record of actions, timestamps, changes and decisions.

9. Questions teammates may ask

Are we building a bank? No. We manage FDR records and workflows; the bank connection is an integration point, simulated for the demo.

Does an uploaded PDF prove the FDR is genuine? No. Authenticity requires an authorised source confirmation or manual verification.

Will AI decide a document is fake? It may flag anomalies, but a flag is not proof. Show evidence and route it for human review.

Will funds be released automatically on maturity? No. Maturity is not permission to release; required checks and authorised approval remain.

Why link FDRs to a Trust/Society? The sponsor may be associated with the deposit and one Trust may relate to multiple institutions; the model must reflect the real arrangement.

What if the bank API is down? Show pending/source unavailable, retry if appropriate and route for manual verification—never silently mark verified.

What does automation mean? Automatic date checks, reminders, routing and logs—not replacing regulatory scrutiny or official decisions.

10. What we must not overclaim

• Do not present ■15–35 lakh or a 10-year term as universal unless the applicable AICTE rule confirms it for that institution/category.
• Do not claim real SBI/HDFC integration without authorised access; call it a mock-bank API.
• Do not label a document fraudulent based only on an automated flag.
• Do not auto-release funds. Preserve authorised human decisions.
• Use synthetic or anonymised data for the demo and protect institutional information.

THE PROBLEM IN 30 SECONDS

AICTE needs a reliable way to know which required security deposits exist, whether their details and restrictions have been checked, when they mature, what needs renewal, and whether release requests have completed required checks. Manual tracking can cause missed deadlines, inconsistent records and slow follow-up. Code Blooded proposes one secure portal with verification workflows, dashboards, automatic reminders and an auditable approval process—while leaving regulatory decisions to authorised officers.

Scope note: This is a plain-English interpretation and prototype plan based on the team-provided SIH 26265 brief. Exact amounts, timelines, lien conditions and release rules must be checked against the current official AICTE Approval Process Handbook and applicable instructions.